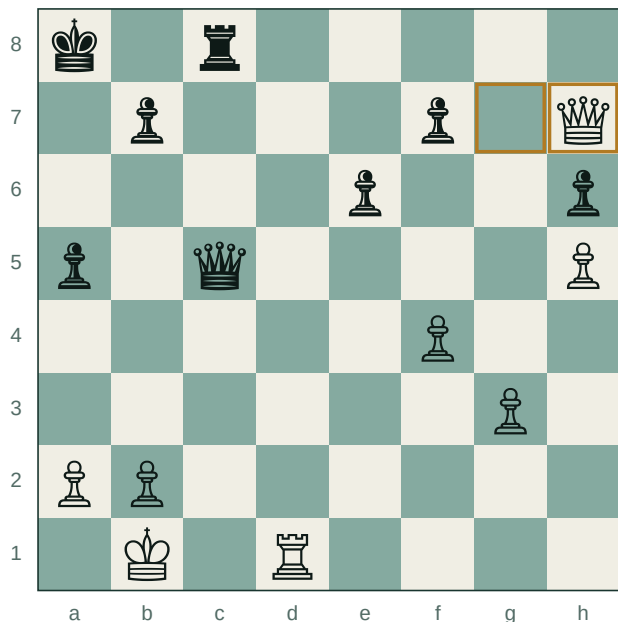


Quiet tactical moves: Black, move 33

Quiet tactical moves

Black to move



Previous move: 33.Qh7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33...f5 34. a3 Qc2+ 35. Ka2 Qxd1

33...f5 The pawn moves from f7 to f5. Recorded reply: **34.a3**.

34...Qc2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From c2 it attacks king on b1 and rook on d1. Recorded reply: **35.Ka2**.

35...Qxd1 The queen captures the rook on d1.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from +0 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on b1. Geometrically undefended: queen on h7 and rook on d1. Check for tactical protection.